

NOTRUMP OPENINGS

These 100 Deals are all about hands that are either opened 1NT or 2NT, or perhaps overcalled 1NT or 2NT. Some of them end up being played at a Notrump contract, but others are played with a trump suit.

The proficiency level for the Deals is Intermediate/Advanced, both in the Bidding and Declarer play.

ABOUT THE DEALS

Each Deal shows only your hand during the Bidding pages. You are asked to decide what bid/call you would make for the hand and when you have decided you click **BID** to go to the next page where the recommended bid is shown with any appropriate comments. This continues throughout the Bidding section, and when the final bid is made your partner's hand is also shown.

With both hands visible and the opening lead noted you are asked to make a Plan for each Deal. You should think this through just as if you were at the table. When you have the Plan in your mind, click **NEXT** to go to the next page.

All of the Notrump Plans include a Winner Count and all Suit Plans include a Loser Count.

During the Bidding section you are in the South position. As a result of that some of the Deals would end up with your partner North as the Declarer. When that happens a page will appear for you to click **ROTATE** to switch the hands so South becomes the Declarer. It is important to note that on this page the complete Bidding Auction is also rotated to correspond with South being Declarer. So if something in the plan depends upon the bidding this is the page to look at, not the earlier bidding pages.

The final page shows the full deal, including the East/West hands.

You may use the left Navigation panel to go to any numbered Deal you like, or you may just go to the next Deal by clicking the link at the bottom of the last page of a Deal.

ABOUT THE BIDDING

Normal 4-3-2-1 point count is used, with 1 length point added for any card more than 4 in any suit.

1NT Opening: 15-17 points

2NT Opening: 20-21 points

1NT Overcall: 15-18 points, at least 1, (preferably 2), stoppers in their suit

2NT Overcall over a Weak 2-bid: 15-18 points, at least 1, (preferably 2), stoppers

Stayman convention is used extensively.

There is Stayman lesson on BakerBridge which can be reached by clicking Home on the menubar.

Jacoby Transfers are used extensively.

In addition to the standard 2♦ transfer to ♥ and 2♥ transfer to ♠ we also use a 2♠ transfer to 3♣.

There is a Jacoby Transfer lesson you can access by clicking Home.

The **lebensohl** convention is used when opponents overcall your side's 1NT opening.

Since this is not a standard for many of you, a brief explanation/comment is given when it occurs.

There is a lebensohl lesson you can access by clicking Home.

You can go either go through the deals in order, or use the Navigation Bar at left.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣10

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣9

Board: 4

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♣

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 8 4

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ J 8 2

♠ A K 6

♥ A 10 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ 10 9 7 4



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ K Q 3

♣ 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A K Q 5 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥K

your two extra winners will be the ♣5 and ♣3.

So after winning the ♥A, you play a ♣ to dummy's ♣Q and breathe a sigh of relief when both defenders follow suit.

UhOh. Surely you didn't play your ♣4 to dummy's ♣Q???

If you did then just look at the situation now. If the ♣J doesn't fall on the next trick the suit will be blocked. Now go back in time and play the ♣10 to dummy's ♣Q.

That's better. Now under the ♣ A K you can unblock the ♣ 9 7, which will leave you with the ♣4 to slip under dummy's ♣5.

Watch those spot cards. You may have to unblock them to stay in the hand you want to be in.

Partner's jump to 3NT is a lebensohl method.

He is describing a hand with which he would have bid 3NT if there had been no overcall. But he is warning you that he **DOES NOT HAVE** a ♥ stopper!

Since you **DO** have a ♥ stopper you decide to pass and play 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥K.

You hold up your ♥A until the third round.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 7

You need two more winners. Barring a 4-0 ♣ split

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5 3

♥ K J 7

♦ 6 2

♣ 8 4

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 5 3 2

♦ Q 10

♣ A J 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A J 8 4 3

♣ Q 7 2

♠ 10 8 7

♥ 10 4

♦ K 9 7 5

♣ K 10 9 5

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♣10

Those losers are based on dummy's hand, not yours. You can figure them either way but it is usually easier to determine losers based on the long-trump hand. It's important to remember it in this Deal because the zero losers in ♥s assumes you will ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Pull one round of trumps with dummy's ♠K. Both defenders follow suit. Play the ♥A, then ♥6 to dummy's ♥K. On this trick South follows with the ♥10.

The Plan is still the same, you will ruff the ♥ in your hand, but you better be sure to ruff with your ♠A. Aha! Your precaution pays off when South shows out of ♥s, but of course he cannot over-ruff your ♠A.

A very good Bridge maxim is this: When you are ruffing, ruff with as high a trump as you can afford.

Here, with only 2 trumps left out, you can afford the ♠A.

You decide to use a transfer so the lead will be into whatever holding partner has in the minor suits. You bid 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

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You are nowhere near strong enough to be thinking of slam so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by West.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♣10. North wins the ♣A. They continue ♣s and you ruff the third one in dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 3

Board 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 3 2
♥ J 9 7 4 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ 9 2

♠ K 10 9 8 6 5

♥ Q

♦ 7 4 2

♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ 10 8 5 2

♦ 9 8 5 3

♣ A 10 8 7

♠ Q J 4

♥ A K 6

♦ K Q J

♣ J 5 4 3

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

Lead: ♣9
are wasting but you can afford it.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 4♠ and you pass.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♣9. East takes the ♣A, then returns the ♣7 on which West plays the ♣2.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3

Careful! Although it looks like only 3 losers you are in real danger of a ♣ ruff. It is almost certain that West has led a doubleton ♣ so if East can get the lead with either ♠A or ♦A they will get the ruff.

Fortunately your ♦s are solid and you do not need the ♥Q as a winner.

So before playing any trumps play ♥A K, discarding dummy's ♣K. That's a lot of winners you

Only then can you afford to play a ♠. East can win the ♠A, but if he plays a ♣ dummy will be able to over-ruff West.

After you pull trumps you can drive out the ♦A and claim the contract.

As you see, trying even one round of trumps would have been fatal.

You had to get rid of dummy's singleton ♥ first - the fact that it was a winner should not affect your making the correct play.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ 9 8 4 2
♦ A K 7 3
♣ K J

♠ K J 7 2

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ Q J 4

♣ A 7



♠ 5 3

♥ 7 6

♦ 10 5

♣ 9 8 6 5 4 3 2

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ A K 5

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ Q 10

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♣			Pass
All Pass			

3♣ by West

Lead: ♥Q

trumps from dummy and the easiest way to get there is to play ♦ A K, then ruff a ♦. Now play a ♣ from dummy and play what from your hand?

You may think it is a guess whether to play the ♣K or ♣J, but there is no guessing involved here. You must play the ♣J because South cannot possibly hold the ♣A. Just go back and look at the bidding again. The South hand failed to open the bidding in first seat. And since then you have seen the ♥ A K and the ♠ Q come out of the hand. That's 9 points and the ♣A would bring that total to 13. Since he passed it follows that he doesn't have the ♣A. Of course he might or might not have the ♣Q, you just have to hope for that card.

It's easy to forget the bidding once you have started playing a hand.

But good players don't forget, they use every bit of information they can get to help them make their contracts. That's why they make more contracts.

Many people play Jacoby Transfer convention. Not all of them play that an initial response of 2♠ asks partner to bid 3♣. You use that here and reply 3♣. Everybody passes.

What a terrible dummy! This shows why this method is a good addition to Jacoby Transfers.

West plays 3♣. North leads the ♥Q. South takes the ♥ A K, then switches to the ♠Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = ? :: Total = 3 + ?

Instead of trying to estimate how many ♣ losers you may have, just tell yourself that you can only afford to lose one! Then you base your plan on that requirement.

You might as well win the ♠A. You need to play the